Final Assignment: Shadow Team A/B Playtesting

Assignment Overview

Your final playtest will focus on applying A/B testing methods to your VR game in order to evaluate design decisions and improve player experience through structured playtesting and peer review.

A/B testing is a common technique used in Game Design and User Experience Design that involves comparing two variations of a design feature to determine which performs better based on player preference or behavior. Constraining your playtester's feedback to selecting which of the two variations they like best can provide valuable insights into the effectiveness of your design choices.

Part A: Develop A/B playtests for three features in your VR game

Part B: Conduct an A/B playtesting session with your shadow team.
Must be completed by Monday (5/4).

Part C: Incorporate A/B playtest results into your game

Part D: Write up play test results and submit to Canvas.
Due by Tues (5/5)

Since the goal of this playtesting assignment is to identify aspects of your VR game that can be meaningfully tested and evaluated using an A/B approach, you need to do the following:

Part A. In this part of the assignment you need to identify three features in your VR game that can be evaluated using A/B testing. These could include core mechanics, game play parameter values/settings, visual styles, control schemes, UI elements, or feedback systems. After identifying these features, you need to modify your game project so that each of these features can be easily toggled between two variations during runtime (i.e. using keyboard inputs, controller button presses, debug menus, inspector variables values, etc.).

Part B. In this part you need to get together with your partner group (listed on the next page) and participate in a shadow team playtesting session. This playtesting session should be scheduled in advance and is expected to last approximately 45 – 60 minutes. During the playtesting session, both teams will exchange games and test each other's projects. Each tester should experience all A/B variations of the three features and provide feedback on which they liked best.

Part C. In this part you need to analyze the feedback provided by your shadow team. Pay close attention to tester preferences, usability issues, and any consistent patterns in feedback across participants. Using this information, implement enhancements and improvements to your game based on the results of your A/B tests.

Part D. Finally, you need to submit a short one-page writeup to Canvas summarizing the features you selected for A/B testing, your A/B testing process, key findings, and how your shadow team influenced your design decisions.

Example A/B Feature Testing

- Moving via teleport versus moving via running in place.
- Configuring the enemies to spawn in batches of a dozen at once, or just single spawns spread evenly over time.
- Variations on physics parameters, speed of response and timing values, hit points, etc.
- Usability of different UI schemes
- Contrasting visual styles
- Different control schemes
- Etc.

Shadow Partner Groups

A/B TEST TEAM 1

Group 1 - Absorb and Shoot Yu Jiang Lobi Zhao Henry Han	**Group 6 - Sonar Bounce** Tianhong Zhou Leo Luo Qingyao Tian

A/B TEST TEAM 2

Group 5 - Cooking Throwdown Silvia Xia Kevin Du Alice Liu	**Group 7 - Fish Catcher** Xiaonan Pan Qirui Fu Pavel Peev

A/B TEST TEAM 3

Group 3 - IcePEAK Yiding Tian Cecilia Chen Jacky Park	**Group 2 - Silhouetto** Aaron Jiang Aaron Tian Daniel Chen

A/B TEST TEAM 4

Group 4 - Final Serve Ruben Young Robles Avi Serebrenik Griffin Evans Constanza De Rienzo	**TAs** Jackie Guan Eli Asimov Caroline Fernandes